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MySQL COUNT() Function

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MySQL COUNT() Function

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The `COUNT()` function returns the number of rows that matches a specified criterion.

COUNT() Syntax

```
SELECT COUNT([DISTINCT] column_name | *)
FROM table_name
WHERE condition;
```

The behavior of `COUNT()` depends on the argument used within the parentheses:

- `COUNT(*)` - Counts the total number of rows in a table (including NULL values).
- `COUNT(columnname)` - Counts all non-null values in the column.

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Demo Database

Below is a selection from the "Products" table in the Northwind sample database:

ProductID	ProductName	SupplierID	CategoryID	Unit	Price
1	Chais	1	1	10 boxes x 20 bags	18.00
2	Chang	1	1	24 - 12 oz bottles	19.00
3	Aniseed Syrup	1	2	12 - 550 ml bottles	10.00
4	Chef Anton's Cajun Seasoning	2	2	48 - 6 oz jars	22.00
5	Chef Anton's Gumbo Mix	2	2	36 boxes	21.35

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Using COUNT(*)

The following SQL uses `COUNT(*)`, and counts the total number of rows in the "Products" table (will include NULL values):

Example

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```
SELECT COUNT(*)
```

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Using COUNT(column_name)

The `COUNT(column_name)` counts all non-null values in the specified column.

The following SQL counts all non-null values of the "ProductName" column:

Example

```
SELECT COUNT(ProductID)
FROM Products;
```

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Using COUNT(DISTINCT column_name)

You can ignore duplicates by using the `DISTINCT` keyword.

The `COUNT(DISTINCT column_name)` counts only the unique, non-null values in the column.

If `DISTINCT` is specified, rows with the same value for the specified column will be counted as one.

The following SQL counts the unique, non-null values of the "Price" column:

Example

How many *different* prices are there in the "Products" table:

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Add a WHERE Clause

You can add a `WHERE` clause to specify conditions:

Example

Count the number of products where Price is higher than 20:

```
SELECT COUNT(ProductID)
FROM Products
WHERE Price > 20;
```

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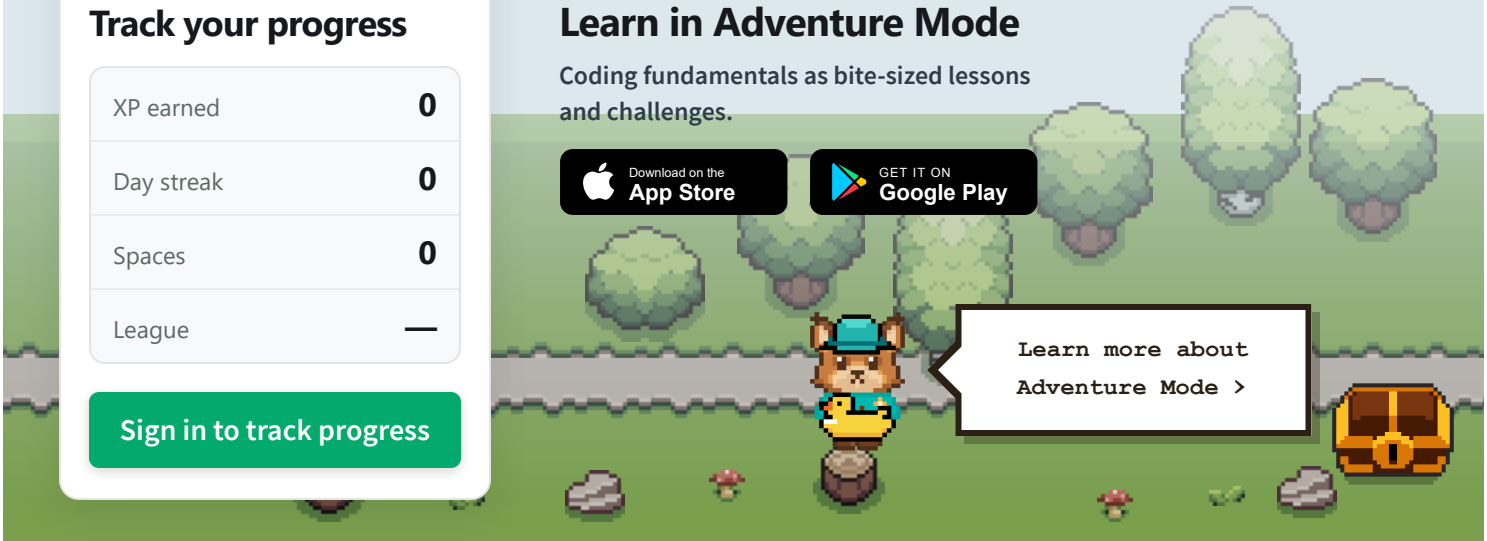
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